IOWN

The Morning Brief

MARCH 28, 2026

Deadline Extended

Trump delays power-plant strikes to April 6 as Brent closes above $112, equities post a fifth consecutive weekly decline, and the Dow enters correction — Weekend Edition.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	BRENT CRUDE (FRI CLOSE)	BITCOIN (LIVE)	GOLD (FRI CLOSE)	FEAR & GREED
6,369 ↓2.1% on the week	**$113 ↑ Highest since July 2022**	**~$66,100 · Below 200-day MA**	**~$4,400 ↓~10% on the week**	**13 · Extreme Fear**

SECTION 01

Markets — Week in Review

FIFTH STRAIGHT WEEKLY DECLINE — DOW ENTERS CORRECTION

The S&P 500 fell 2.1% on the week to 6,369, marking what CNBC reported as the fifth consecutive weekly decline—the longest losing streak since 2022. The Dow dropped 1.73% on Friday alone to 45,166, officially entering correction territory alongside the Nasdaq, which now sits approximately 13% below its October record. Friday's session accelerated the damage: Brent crude surged 4.2% to $112.57, WTI briefly touched $100 for the first time since 2022, and the VIX surged to approximately 31, its highest sustained level in over a year. Only energy posted a meaningful gain for the week as the war premium continued to widen. The dividend sleeve outperformed again: DVY gained ground while IUSG shed nearly 3% on Thursday alone.

S&P 500	**6,369 · ↓2.1% on the week · 5th consecutive weekly decline**
DOW	**45,166 · Entered correction territory Friday**
BRENT CRUDE	**$112.57 · WTI touched $100 · Highest since July 2022**
GOLD	**~$4,400 · ↓~10% on the week**
10-YEAR YIELD	**4.44% · Highest since July 2025**
VIX	**~31 · Highest sustained level in over a year**

RATE HIKE ODDS CROSS 50% — THE STAGFLATION SIGNAL INTENSIFIES

Fed funds futures now price a greater than 50% probability of a rate hike by year-end 2026—the first time this threshold has been crossed since the conflict began. The 10-year yield rose to 4.44% on Friday, its highest level since July 2025, even as equities sold off—bonds offered no refuge. The OECD's revised US inflation forecast of 4.2%, combined with February's payroll contraction of 92,000 jobs, paints the stagflation picture the Fed has been trying to avoid. The next PCE release is April 9. For IOWN, this environment structurally favors the dividend sleeve's cash-generat-

> ive holdings and the energy sleeve’s inflation-linked revenues over duration-sensitive names.

Five weeks of declines. Both the Dow and Nasdaq in correction. Oil above $112. Rate hike odds above 50%. The portfolio was built for sustained uncertainty, not for calm—and it is performing accordingly. Think Like an Owner.

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

TRUMP EXTENDS STRIKE DEADLINE TO APRIL 6 — BUYING TIME, NOT RESOLUTION

The most significant weekend development: Trump issued a second postponement of power-plant strikes, pushing the deadline from the original late-March window to April 6 at 8:00 PM ET. He cited productive conversations facilitated through Pakistani mediators, though Iran's parliament speaker publicly denied any negotiations are taking place and characterized the claim as market manipulation. The gap between the two positions remains unchanged—Iran's five-point counter-demands, including war reparations and full Hormuz sovereignty, are functionally incompatible with Washington's requirements. The extension buys time for diplomacy but does not narrow the substantive distance between the parties. Meanwhile, according to Axios, the Pentagon has prepared contingency plans for an operation against Kharg Island, through which 90% of Iran's oil exports historically flowed. Iran is reportedly fortifying the island with additional air defenses. Gulf allies are privately urging restraint. The April 6 deadline now aligns uncomfortably with the mid-April reserve depletion window identified in prior analysis.

HORMUZ IS FUNCTIONALLY CLOSED — THE DUAL BLOCKADE HAS NO MODERN PRECEDENT

Vessel tracking data cited by CNBC reveals the scale of the Hormuz disruption: only 142 ships transited the strait between March 1 and March 25, compared with 2,652 during the same period in 2025. On March 25, a single container ship and zero tankers passed through—versus a historical daily average of approximately 138 vessels. Iran has implemented what analysts are calling a toll-booth system, charging millions of dollars per transit; at least two vessels reportedly paid in yuan. Nearly 2,000 ships remain stranded near the strait. Compounding the disruption, Houthi attacks in the Red Sea resumed on February 28, meaning both Hormuz and the Suez alternative are simultaneously obstructed—a scenario the IEA has characterized as the largest supply disruption in the history of the oil market. Goldman Sachs estimates the geopolitical risk premium embedded in Brent at $14–$18 per barrel. For IOWN's energy sleeve, the duration of this dual blockade directly supports the thesis for CVX, VLO, and OKE.

TROOP BUILDUP ACCELERATES — OVER 50,000 IN THEATER

US force posture continues to expand. The 82nd Airborne Division's deployment of 2,000–3,000 paratroopers is underway, joining two Marine Expeditionary Units already en route. Approximately 50,000 US military personnel are already in the broader theater, with an additional 8,000 troops deploying. The human cost continues to mount: Iran's Health Ministry reports approximately 1,900 killed since February 28, Lebanon's Health Ministry reports 1,116 from related Israeli strikes, and 13 US service members have been killed with approximately 290 wounded. India is rekindling energy ties with Russia to hedge against Gulf supply disruption, according to Reuters. Europe is scaling back climate targets to ease the energy shock. The war's ripple effects are reshaping alliances and energy policy across four continents. GD and LMT, IOWN's defense holdings, have outperformed the broader market throughout the conflict as the fiscal beneficiaries of an extended engagement.

STRIKE DEADLINE	**Extended to April 6 at 8:00 PM ET**
HORMUZ TRANSITS	**142 ships (Mar 1–25) vs. 2,652 same period 2025**
US FORCE POSTURE	**~50K in theater · Additional 8K deploying**
BRENT RISK PREMIUM	**$14–$18/bbl (Goldman Sachs est.)**
DUAL BLOCKADE	**Hormuz + Red Sea simultaneously obstructed**

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead: ISM Manufacturing, Nike, Good Friday. Tuesday brings Consumer Confidence and Nike (NKE) earnings after the close—consensus expects EPS near $0.28 after China revenues declined 16% in the prior quarter, a direct read on whether consumer demand is deteriorating further in the war environment. Wednesday delivers the March ISM Manufacturing PMI; February's reading of 52.4 was expansionary but the prices-paid subindex hit 70.5, its highest since June 2022, underscoring energy-driven cost pressure across industrials. JOLTS job openings and ADP employment also arrive Wednesday. Markets are closed Friday for Good Friday. March nonfarm payrolls may shift to Thursday given the holiday—a potential volatility catalyst on a shortened trading week. February payrolls contracted by 92,000 jobs.

2. The April 6 deadline and mid-April reserve depletion are converging. Thursday's brief identified a reserve depletion window of approximately April 10–14, when the combined IEA and SPR releases could be exhausted if Hormuz remains closed. Trump's extension of the strike deadline to April 6 creates a scenario in which two critical thresholds—the military escalation trigger and the reserve buffer expiration—could arrive within the same week. If April 6 passes without resolution and reserves run dry days later, there may be no policy lever remaining to contain oil prices. The energy sleeve is positioned for this scenario. Research Reveals Opportunities.

3. Bitcoin has fallen below the 200-day moving average over the weekend. BTC is trading near $66,100 as of Saturday morning, below the $69,200 level identified as the 200-day moving average earlier this week. Ethereum is near $1,980, below its 50-day EMA. The crypto Fear & Greed index sits at 12. On the constructive side, Morgan Stanley's spot Bitcoin ETF (MSBT) received its NYSE listing notice this week with a market-leading 14 basis point fee—the structural significance of Morgan Stanley's 16,000 financial advisors gaining access to a proprietary BTC product could be material on a medium-term horizon, regardless of near-term price action. Think Like an Owner.

4. SMIC-Iran semiconductor allegations confirmed at the administration level. Two senior Trump administration officials confirmed to Reuters that SMIC has been sending semiconductor manufacturing equipment to Iran's military industrial complex for approximately one year, with collaboration that reportedly included technical training. It remains unclear whether the tools contained US-origin components, which would constitute a direct sanctions violation. If formal sanctions follow, the cascade risk through global semiconductor supply chains could pressure equipment makers including Lam Research and Applied Materials, adding another layer of uncertainty to IOWN's semi sleeve. Avoid Erosion.

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